

your friends talking to you in a small window. Search is integrated with the phone service, which makes it easy to find numbers.

The extra services that come with Windows Live Messenger are perhaps the most attractive (or most annoying, depending on point of view) feature. Just by opening your chat window you can bid on eBay, visit Xbox Live (and also see your contacts' status if they are on Xbox Live), get news, chat with bots, play games with friends, listen to music, invest in stocks, find a date at Match.com, watch free Live videos...

When it comes to interoperability, Messenger users can natively chat with Yahoo! Messenger users, while they can be accessed by most major multi-protocol clients.

Apart from sharing files, you can also collaborate on a document. Changes you make to a document are immediately updated and viewable. Anti-virus protection is incorporated with the service, and files are encrypted before being sent. There is no limit on file size, and if the power goes off, the next time you log on, the transfer will resume from where it had stopped.

4.1.3 Yahoo! Messenger

Yahoo! Messenger works best on Windows, with the latest version being Yahoo! Messenger 9 Beta for Windows. For Linux, rpm and deb packages are available for older versions, while for Mac, the latest stable version is Yahoo! Messenger 2.5.3. Here we'll discuss the Yahoo! Messenger features for Windows.

Yahoo! Messenger can be installed in two ways: either you download the client from www.messenger.yahoo.com/download.php and install it, or use a Web-based installation from <http://webmessenger.yahoo.com>. For the second option you need to be online, as most of the data needed for installation is based on the server. This will take some time, so we suggest you go with the offline installation.

The first thing to do after installation is to key in the network settings. Select Messenger > Connection Preferences and click on



All your contacts at one place